30-DAY GIT LEARNING SERIES

GIT QUEST

LEVEL 4

git add and Good Commit Messages

Week 1: First Steps | Absolute Beginner

QUEST PROGRESS: DAY 4 OF 30

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The Story: The Mystery Box

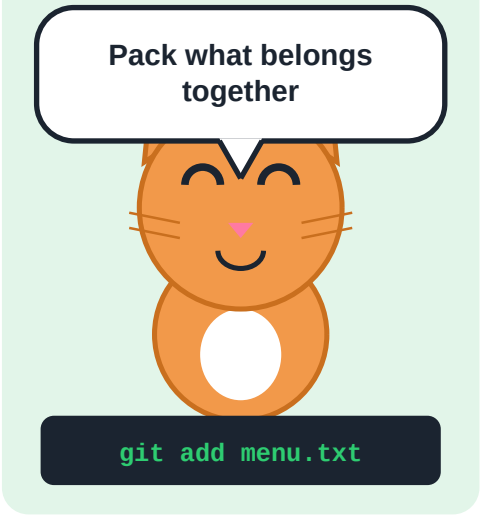
Commit the Cat finds a box in the cupboard. What is inside?

1

A bad label

A message like 'stuff' tells future you nothing. Six months later it is a mystery.

2



git add

Pick the files for one change. One file, a few files, or everything with git add .

3

A good label

Short, starts with a verb, no full stop. It says exactly what is inside.

4

git log

Good labels turn your history into a story you can read in seconds.

Anatomy of a Great Commit Message

Small habits that make your history easy to read.

A GREAT COMMIT MESSAGE LOOKS LIKE THIS

```
feat: Add dessert section to menu
```

type (optional) — short summary: starts with a verb, no full stop, under 50 characters

BAD LABELS

- ✗ `stuff`
- ✗ `fix`
- ✗ `asdfgh`
- ✗ `final changes!!!`
- ✗ `Added login, fixed bug, updated docs`

GOOD LABELS

- ✓ `Add menu with three dishes`
- ✓ `Fix typo in menu title`
- ✓ `Add notes file`
- ✓ `Update todo list with deadlines`
- ✓ `Three small commits, one per change`

THE MAGIC TEST

If applied, this commit will _____ .

Add menu = makes sense. stuff = does not.

Quest Board: Label Your Boxes

Finish 4 quests, then collect 3 commits as loot.

1 Start a practice repo

```
$ git init -b main commit-lab
$ cd commit-lab
```

2 Create three files

```
$ echo "Pasta" > menu.txt
$ echo "Ideas" > notes.txt
$ echo "Call mom" > todo.txt
```

3 Add ONE file, label it clearly

```
$ git add menu.txt
$ git commit -m "Add menu"
```

4 Add TWO files, then read the story

```
$ git add notes.txt todo.txt
$ git commit -m "Add notes and todo files"
$ git log --oneline
```

LOOT: TODAY'S 3 COMMITS

COMMIT 1

day04-commit-messages/lesson.md

```
docs(day04): add lesson on git add and commit messages
```

The lesson: labels, rules and examples.

COMMIT 2

day04-commit-messages/demo.tape

```
feat(day04): add VHS tape for commit message demo
```

Script that records the terminal GIF.

COMMIT 3

exercise.md + days-1-to-4-summary.md

```
docs(day04): add exercise and days 1-4 summary
```

Challenge, plus a recap of Days 1 to 4.

Tip: read each message aloud with 'If applied, this commit will...' before you press Enter.

Boss Fight and Bonus Loot

Cheat sheet, golden rules, quiz, and your next unlock.

BONUS 1: DAY 4 CHEAT SHEET

```
git add menu.txt            Stage one file
git add a.txt b.txt          Stage several files
git add .                   Stage all changes here
git commit -m "summary"     Save with a label
git commit -m "s" -m "body"  Add a longer note
git log --oneline           Read your history
```

BONUS 2: THE 5 GOLDEN RULES

```
1. Summary under 50 characters
2. Start with a verb: Add, Fix, Update, Remove
3. No full stop at the end
4. One commit = one logical change
5. Say WHAT changed (the body says WHY)
```

BONUS 3: TYPES YOU WILL SEE EVERYWHERE

```
feat:      a new feature
fix:       a bug fix
docs:      documentation only
chore:     housekeeping
refactor:  tidy up, same behavior
```

BOSS FIGHT: QUICK QUIZ

1. Which is better: 'Added menu' or 'Add menu'?
2. What does git add . do?
3. How many changes should one commit contain?

Answers: 1) Add menu (a command, not past tense) 2) Stages all changes in this folder 3) One logical change

CHALLENGE

Rewrite these labels so each one passes the magic test: 'stuff', 'fix', 'final changes!!!'.

LEVEL 5: git log, your time machine

Unlocks tomorrow. Travel back through your history and see every save point.

LOCKED